

Hermes Desktop for Linux

Usage Guide · v0.18.2 · linux-x64 · portable Electron build

Hermes Desktop lets you launch Hermes Agent commands without opening a terminal or remembering command names. A desktop window opens with the available Hermes commands right there — you just pick one and run it.

This guide covers two things: (1) getting the app from the GitHub repo, and (2) using the app itself. Everything below assumes a 64-bit Linux desktop with a graphical display.

1. Get it from GitHub

1. Open the repository: <https://github.com/jdvann/hermes-linux-launcher>
2. Go to **Releases** (link on the right sidebar, or the `releases/latest` URL in the README).
3. Download the asset `hermes-desktop-linux.zip` (~133 MB). It bundles the full Electron runtime, Chromium, Node.js, and all native libraries — there is nothing else to install from the repo.

The ZIP is not committed to the repo tree because GitHub caps repo files at 100 MB; the app is ~133 MB. Always grab it from the **Releases** page, not the file browser.

2. Install (unzip and run)

No package manager, no build step. Just extract the ZIP:

```
unzip hermes-desktop-linux.zip
cd hermes-desktop-linux
chmod +x launch.sh
./launch.sh
```

A window appears with the available Hermes commands — pick one and run it. No terminal, no memorizing command names.

Requirements

- A graphical display (X11 or Wayland).
- The `hermes` CLI on your `PATH` — the desktop app drives the same agent core as the CLI. Install Hermes Agent first (`pip install hermes-agent` or the official installer) and confirm with `hermes --version`.
- Standard Linux desktop libraries. If the app fails to start with a "missing shared library" error, install Electron's runtime deps (see section 5).

3. Using the app

1. **Launch** the app with `./launch.sh`. A desktop window opens.
2. **Browse / pick** the Hermes command you want from the window — no need to recall the exact command name or flags.
3. **Run** it. The app invokes the same agent core the `hermes` CLI uses, so results match what you would get in a terminal.
4. **Repeat** as needed; close the window when done.

Think of it as a graphical command launcher for Hermes: the same tasks you would type into a shell, selected from a list instead.

4. How launching works

`launch.sh` starts the bundled Electron binary (`linux-unpacked/Hermes`) with `--no-sandbox`. The app auto-discovers the `hermes` CLI on your `PATH`. Optional environment variables:

Variable	Effect
<code>HERMES_DESKTOP_CWD</code>	Directory desktop sessions start in (defaults to where you run the script).
<code>HERMES_DESKTOP_HERMES_ROOT</code>	Point at a specific Hermes source tree instead of the CLI on <code>PATH</code> .
<code>HERMES_DESKTOP_DISABLE_G</code>	Set to <code>1</code> if you hit rendering issues on a headless/remote display.

5. Fixing "missing shared library"

If the app won't start, install Electron's runtime dependencies for your distro.

Debian / Ubuntu

```
sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get install -y \
  libnss3 libnspr4 libatk1.0-0 libatk-bridge2.0-0 libcups2 \
  libdrm2 libdbus-1-3 libexpat1 libgbm1 libgtk-3-0 libasound2 \
  libx11-6 libxcomposite1 libxcursor1 libxdamage1 libxext6 \
  libxfixes3 libxi6 libxrandr2 libxrender1 libxss1 libxtst6 \
  libpango-1.0-0 libcairo2 libatspi2.0-0
```

Fedora / RHEL

```
sudo dnf install -y nss nspr atk at-spi2-atk cups-libs libdrm \
  dbus-libs expat mesa-libgbm gtk3 alsa-lib libX11 libXcomposite \
  libXcursor libXdamage libXext libXfixes libXi libXrandr libXrender \
  libXScrnSaver libXtst pango cairo at-spi2-core
```

6. About --no-sandbox

The packaged `chrome-sandbox` SUID helper (mode 4755, owned by root) cannot survive being zipped and extracted by a non-root user, so the launcher runs Electron with `--no-sandbox`. This is the standard, safe way to run Electron on a single-user Linux desktop.

To restore the real Chromium sandbox after extraction, run as root:

```
sudo chown root:root linux-unpacked/chrome-sandbox
sudo chmod 4755 linux-unpacked/chrome-sandbox
```

...then edit `launch.sh` to drop the `--no-sandbox` flag.

Quick reference

Task	Do this
Download	GitHub → Releases → <code>hermes-desktop-linux.zip</code>
Run	<code>./launch.sh</code> (after <code>chmod +x</code>)
Pick a command	Use the window — no terminal needed
Point at a Hermes source	Set <code>HERMES_DESKTOP_HERMES_ROOT</code>
Fix missing libs	Install deps in section 5

Hermes Desktop for Linux · App v0.18.2 · Electron 40.10.2 · linux-x64 · Built from the Hermes Agent `apps/desktop` → `linux-unpacked` target. Repo: <https://github.com/jdvann/hermes-linux-launcher>